

Tomato Pasta (Tom Pasta)

Serves: 4 | Prep: 5 min | Cook: 20 min

INGREDIENTS

- 400g spaghetti or pasta of choice
- 2 x 400g cans crushed/whole peeled tomatoes
- 4 garlic cloves, thinly sliced
- 1/4 cup extra-virgin olive oil
- 1 tsp dried oregano or fresh basil
- 1/4 tsp chilli flakes
- 1 tsp sugar (to balance acidity)
- Salt & black pepper to taste
- Large handful fresh basil
- Parmesan, freshly grated, to serve

METHOD

Step 1

Bring a large pot of generously salted water to a boil. Cook pasta to al dente per packet. Reserve 1 cup pasta water before draining.

Step 2

Meanwhile, heat olive oil in a large saucepan over medium heat. Add garlic and chilli flakes. Gently sauté for 1–2 minutes until fragrant and lightly golden — do not let it burn.

Step 3

Add canned tomatoes, oregano, sugar, salt and pepper. Stir and simmer for 15 minutes, breaking up whole tomatoes with a spoon. The sauce should thicken slightly.

Step 4

Add drained pasta directly to the sauce. Toss vigorously, adding a splash of pasta water to loosen if needed.

Step 5

Remove from heat, tear in fresh basil and toss again. Serve topped with freshly grated parmesan.

TIPS & NOTES

- ◆ *Quality tinned tomatoes make all the difference — San Marzano varieties are worth it.*
- ◆ *Never throw away pasta water — it makes the sauce glossy and helps it cling to the pasta.*
- ◆ *For a richer sauce, stir in 2 tbsp of butter at the end. Silky and incredible.*